

CITY OF AUSTIN

Colorado River Civic Waterfront

Request for Qualifications

Landscape Architecture + Urban Design
Solicitation DEMO-CRCW-2026-01

Issued	14 September 2026
Response due	16 October 2026 at 2:00 PM Central Daylight Time
Anticipated start	January 2027
Planning construction budget	\$72,000,000
Study area	Approximately 22 acres of downtown riverfront

FICTIONAL PROCUREMENT FOR SOFTWARE TESTING

This document is a simulated City of Austin solicitation. It is not an actual City publication, funding commitment or invitation to submit. Locations, procurement terms and project boundaries are invented. No real submission portal is provided.

01 / Project & purpose

The City seeks a consultant team to plan and design the Colorado River Civic Waterfront, an approximately 22-acre public landscape along the downtown Colorado River in Austin, Texas. The project will connect civic gathering areas, continuous trails, ecological restoration and mobility links through a resilient landscape framework.

The study area is a fictional planning envelope along the downtown riverfront. Surveyed limits, ownership, easements and existing utility information will be furnished after selection. No parcel identifiers or final boundary survey accompany this RFQ.

Public outcomes

Create a continuous accessible waterfront route. Provide shaded gathering places that support daily use and civic events. Restore riparian planting and improve landscape recovery after inundation. Connect nearby streets, cycling routes and transit approaches while preserving safe service and emergency access.

Budget & scope basis

The current planning construction budget is \$72 million in nominal USD for the overall public-space program. It is not the consultant fee. The consultant fee, reimbursables and subconsultant allocations will be negotiated with the selected team. A landscape design fee cannot be inferred directly from the construction budget.

Project uncertainties

Final phasing depends on site investigations, public engagement, approvals and funding availability. Floodplain performance, bank stability, utilities and maintenance access require coordinated technical review. The City has not established a guaranteed construction start date.

02 / Scope of services

Phase	Expected services and deliverables
1. Discovery	Review records; coordinate survey and geotechnical inputs; map opportunities and constraints; prepare an engagement plan and baseline site assessment.
2. Framework	Develop alternatives, access concepts, resilience objectives and preliminary cost comparisons. Conduct public workshops and document tradeoffs.
3. Design	Prepare schematic design, design development and construction documents with coordinated landscape, civil, structural, lighting and ecological inputs. Update cost estimates at each milestone.
4. Procurement support	Respond to bidder questions and assist with technical clarifications. Construction procurement will be separately administered.
5. Construction phase	Review submittals, respond to information requests, participate in site observations and prepare landscape establishment guidance. Final services will be negotiated.

Team disciplines

The prime may be a landscape architecture or multidisciplinary design practice. Identify a Texas-registered landscape architect responsible for landscape services. The team must provide landscape architecture, urban design, civil engineering, hydrology/hydraulics, structural engineering, ecological restoration, lighting, cost estimating and community engagement. Specialist disciplines may be subconsultants.

Coordination expectations

Describe responsibility for floodplain analysis, permitting coordination, utilities, accessible routes and maintenance planning. Do not represent conceptual landscape resilience as a substitute for hydraulic analysis. Consultant organization and discipline coverage must be explicit.

03 / Qualifications & evaluation

Minimum response requirements

Identify the prime legal entity, authorized contact and responsible Texas-registered landscape architect. Provide three comparable projects completed within the ten years preceding the response deadline. At least one must demonstrate public-sector coordination. Disclose proposed subconsultants, conflicts and any material limitations on staffing availability.

Comparable experience

Demonstrate major public-realm or waterfront experience, multidisciplinary delivery and community engagement. Texas municipal experience and resilient landscape design are preferred. There is no mandatory minimum construction value or requirement that every reference be a waterfront project.

Evaluation criterion	Points
Comparable public-realm experience and delivery	30
Proposed team, roles and individual experience	25
Approach, resilience and engagement	25
Schedule, availability and delivery capacity	10
Texas municipal coordination and local context	10
Total	100

Selection process

The evaluation panel expects to shortlist up to three teams for interviews. Written qualifications inform shortlisting; interviews clarify team responsibilities, approach and availability. The City intends to negotiate scope and compensation with the highest-ranked team. If agreement cannot be reached, it may end negotiations and approach the next-ranked team.

Fee proposal

Do not include a fee proposal, hourly rates or pricing schedules in the qualifications response. Compensation will be requested during negotiations. These simulated procurement rules apply only to this fictional exercise.

04 / Response instructions

Required component	Content
Cover letter	Identify prime, contact and acceptance of RFQ requirements; maximum two pages.
Firm and team	Organization chart, discipline coverage, subconsultants and responsibilities.
Comparable projects	Three project sheets showing scope, client, dates, construction-value basis and named team-member roles.
Key-person resumes	Principal-in-charge, project manager and discipline leads. State each person's current responsibilities and relevant work.
Approach	Explain public engagement, resilience, design coordination and cost control.
Schedule and capacity	Provide anticipated design milestones and availability at January 2027 mobilization. Identify competing commitments.
Disclosures	Conflicts, exceptions and acknowledgment of issued addenda.
References	Three client references with project connection and contact information. Fictional test responses may use reserved .example addresses.

File and page limits

Submit one searchable PDF, maximum 30 pages excluding the front cover, table of contents and addendum acknowledgment forms. All other content, including cover letter, resumes and project sheets, counts toward the limit. Use US Letter pages, minimum 10-point body text and a file size no greater than 25 MB.

Delivery

For this simulation, the response is considered received when the test operator records the upload before 2:00 PM CDT on 16 October 2026. Name the file CRCW_PrimeFirm_Qualifications.pdf. No actual City portal or real email address should be used. Late or incomplete responses may be excluded in the test scenario.

05 / Schedule & communications

Milestone	Date / time (Central)
RFQ issue	14 September 2026
Optional information session	23 September 2026, 10:00 AM CDT
Written questions due	30 September 2026, 5:00 PM CDT
Anticipated final addendum	7 October 2026
Qualifications due	16 October 2026, 2:00 PM CDT
Shortlist notice (anticipated)	30 October 2026
Interviews (anticipated)	10 November 2026, time to be confirmed
Negotiations (anticipated)	November-December 2026
Design mobilization (anticipated)	January 2027

Communications protocol

Direct all simulated questions to Avery Sloan, Procurement Coordinator, at procurement@civicwaterfront.example. This reserved address does not accept real submissions. Do not contact selection-panel members or elected officials regarding the RFQ in the scenario.

Addenda

Only written addenda modify the RFQ. None are included in this initial issue. Oral statements at the optional session are nonbinding. Respondents must acknowledge each addendum issued before the submission deadline.

Working schedule after selection

For planning, assume approximately 18 months for discovery through construction documents, beginning January 2027. Construction-phase services depend on subsequent procurement and funding. The selected team will develop a baseline schedule during negotiations.

06 / Commercial assumptions

Scope and compensation

The final agreement will define task budgets, deliverables, consultant responsibilities, reimbursables and change-control procedures. The City has not published a design-fee allowance. No exclusivity or award is created by a response.

Risk allocation

Selected consultants will be expected to carry commercially appropriate professional, general and workers compensation coverage. Insurance limits and contract language will be supplied during negotiations. Respondents should identify material exceptions when that agreement is available; this RFQ alone is insufficient to assess final contractual risk.

Records and representations

Provide accurate project roles and distinguish firm experience from individual experience gained elsewhere. Clearly label construction budgets as estimated or delivered, and identify whole-development costs where relevant. The evaluation may request supporting records for project claims.

Reserved discretion

The simulated owner may amend or cancel this solicitation, reject responses or adjust the anticipated schedule. Respondents bear their own pursuit costs. No fee is paid for qualifications preparation.

Source record

Document ID	FW-O01
Version	1.0 / Initial issue / 14 September 2026
Included attachments	None
Missing at issue	Survey; parcel limits; geotechnical reports; draft agreement; design-fee budget
Simulation status	Entire solicitation is fictional and exists solely for Firm AI demonstration and ingestion testing